Procedure 227.1A Employment of or Teaching Family/Household Members

Policy 227 - Employment of or Teaching Family/Household Members Policy

Purpose

This procedure outlines the process for disclosing family/household member relationships as it relates to the Employment of or Teaching Family/Household Members Policy 227. Additionally, Lower Columbia College recognizes that there are existing relationships where an employee is in a supervisory role or falls within the supervisory chain of command of a family/household member. This procedure addresses how to handle existing family/household member relationships as of 1/2/19.

Process for Reporting Family/Household Member Relationships

After a committee member becomes aware that a family/household member has applied for a position that the employee is serving on the hiring committee for, and/or has other involvement in the recruitment process for that position, the employee must report it to HR immediately and recuse themselves from the committee and other parts of the hiring process. HR will designate someone else to serve in their place.

Faculty and staff are responsible for reporting to Human Resources when a family/household member is hired if they are within the supervisory chain of

command. HR will document reported family/household member relationships in both employees' personnel files.

Faculty employees will inform HR of any potential conflicts of interest involving family members or household members who are enrolled or potentially enrolled in their course.

Existing Family/Household Member Relationships

Faculty and staff who have a current family/household member for whom they are in a supervisory role, or where the family/household member is up or down the chain of command, are required to report it to Human Resources. Human Resources will review the information and document the relationship in both employees' personnel files.

HR/Dean Approval

In the event that a family/household member is hired and they are within in the supervisory chain of command, HR will review the department/division structure and look at alternate reporting structure options. One alternative may be that the chain of command will skip the level where the conflict of interest occurs. Some circumstances may require HR to make an exception to Policy 227.

In the event that a family/household member is enrolled in a faculty's course, the Dean will review course alternatives to remove the family/household member from the faculty's course. One alternative may be that the student switches to another section of the course. Some circumstances may require a Dean and HR to make an exception to Policy 227 and allow the student to remain in the family/household member's course, but with the Dean or another faculty member's review of coursework and grade assignments.

Violations

If an employee does not self-report and is determined to have violated this policy, the College may impose disciplinary action up to and including termination in accordance with College policies and applicable collective

bargaining agreements. The employee may be subject to mandatory training, transfer, or reassignment.

Procedure History

- Approved by ELT: June 17, 2026
- Reviewed by Governance Council: May 26, 2026
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- Reviewed by ELT: 5/20/2026
- Reviewed by Governance Council: 2/5/2025
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- Reviewed by UMCC: 11/20/2018
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